

ABINAYA S – INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

ORACLE PLACEMENT PROCESS EXPERIENCE:

ABOUT THE COMPANY:

Oracle Corporation is a leading global technology company specializing in database software, cloud services, and enterprise software solutions. Known for its flagship Oracle Database, the company also provides a comprehensive suite of cloud computing services, including infrastructure, applications, and security solutions. Oracle's significant acquisitions, such as PeopleSoft, Sun Microsystems, and NetSuite, have expanded its product portfolio, making it a key player in various industries. Additionally, Oracle owns the Java programming language and integrates AI and machine learning into its offerings to drive innovation and automation.

OVERVIEW OF THE PROCESS:

The placement selection process consisted of several stages, starting with an online test, followed by technical interviews, and finally an HR round.

1. Online Test

The first stage was an online test, which was a mix of technical and aptitude-based questions. It included:

- MCQs related to Operating Systems (OS), Database Management Systems (DBMS), Computer Networks(CN) and Aptitude.
- Comprehension questions to evaluate reading and understanding abilities.
- 1 coding question titled "Efficient Harvest." The question involved calculating the maximum profit by selecting segments of data and optimizing it using a sliding window technique.

2. Technical Interview-1

The first technical interview began with questions about my **resume** and a few questions like "Tell me about yourself." They focused on checking my

understanding of **Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)** concepts. The interviewer asked me to explain the following with real-time examples:

- Polymorphism
- Abstraction
- Encapsulation
- Inheritance (with a discussion on types of inheritance)

The questions were asked to evaluate not just theoretical knowledge but also the logic behind OOP concepts. Additionally, I was asked to compare Array vs. Linked List, and there were discussions on the use of `this` pointer and `super()`.

For the coding part, I was asked to:

- Find the **first duplicated element** in an array, for which I had to provide **brute-force, better, and optimal solutions** while discussing their time and space complexities.

3. Technical Interview-2

The second technical interview focused on SQL queries and coding. The interviewer gave me two database tables and asked me to write several SQL queries for like 10-15 scenarios:

- Basic SELECT queries
- ORDER BY, GROUP BY, JOINS, and sub-queries

I was then given an application format and was asked to write **HTML and CSS** code according to specific requirements.

For coding part, the problem was to find the **sum of composite numbers** from 1 to `n`. I was again expected to provide brute-force, better, and optimal solutions while discussing the efficiency of each approach.

The interviewer also asked me about my project domain (NLP) and the use of APIs in my project.

4. HR Interview

The HR interview focused on assessing my **communication skills** and overall personality. The questions included:

- Tell me about yourself
- Strengths and weaknesses
- Details about my project
- Hobbies: I mentioned that I enjoy reading, and I was asked to name a few books I had read recently, the author, reasons for choosing those books, and a summary of each book.
- My experience with learning the French language was also discussed, specifically why I chose to learn it.

The HR interview was mostly conversational to know how well I could express myself and my thought process.

TIPS AND TRICKS:

- Platforms like LeetCode, HackerRank, and Codeforces are great for practicing coding problems.
- Start with basic data structures like arrays, linked lists, stacks, and queues to strengthen your foundation.
- Gradually proceed to complex ones like trees, graphs, heaps, and tries.
- Always analyze the time and space complexity of every problem you work on.
- Develop the habit of solving problems using brute force first, then move to better and optimal solutions.
- Maintain a separate notebook to note down key concepts, approaches, and solutions.
- I used resources like Striver's A-Z DSA sheets, SDE sheets, and placement materials from seniors for preparation.

- Read technical subjects such as OS, DBMS, CN, and OOP, and make note of key points for last-minute revision.
- Once shortlisted for an interview, research the company and look for interview experiences online or from seniors.
- Prepare for common HR questions and practice speaking to avoid hesitation.
- Always think of optimal solutions (in terms of time and space complexity) when solving coding questions.
- Be able to explain OOP concepts like inheritance, polymorphism, abstraction, and encapsulation with real-world examples.
- Know how to solve common Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) problems like sorting, searching, and traversing arrays, trees, and linked lists. Be prepared to explain the time and space complexity of your solution.
- Practice SQL queries on various scenarios, including joins, subqueries, and grouping functions.
- Explain your approach clearly and logically when writing code on a paper.
- Know your project inside-out. Be able to explain your role, technologies used, and how you solved specific problems. Be prepared for detailed technical discussions on APIs and the domain.
- Practice your self-introduction with your academic background, projects, skills, and interests.
- Prepare yourself for question like your strengths and weakness beforehand and don't think of a new answer at the time of interview.
- HR rounds mostly test our communication skills. Stay calm, and answer questions about hobbies, books, and languages fluently.